

LOCAL NEWS JULY 29, 2011

Pick up great reads for summer



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Summer is here. Whether you're going on vacation or just hanging out around town, summer is a great time to read, so this week we thought we'd just offer a list of staff recommendations. I also solicited suggestions from the Potlatch and Troy Friends of the library groups through their Facebook pages. Both the Potlatch and Troy Friends now have their own Facebook pages where you can keep up on news about the Potlatch and Troy libraries.

A few weeks ago I wrote about the new James Bond book by Jeffrey Deaver, "Carte Blanche," and I'd highly recommend it for anyone who wants to read an action-adventure novel this summer. Deaver put to rest any fears I had about reading a Bond novel by someone other than Ian Fleming. It isn't just a good Bond novel since Fleming's death - it's one of the best ever.

From Potlatch, Khaliela recommended the book, "These Is My Words," by Nancy E. Turner. Khaliela said it's written from the point of view of an early settler who lacks a formal education, and it's a great read for single moms.

Also from Potlatch, Diane said after reading "The Girl With the Dragon Tattoo" books by Stieg Larsson, she read "The Hypnotist," by Lars Kepler, which is a great book in the same vein.

From Troy, Faye recommended "The Immortal Life of Henrietta Lacks," by Rebecca Skloot, which is an interesting read about the woman whose cell cultures were used as the foundation for great advances in medicine in the last half of the 20th century.

Five Nobel prizes have been awarded to researchers who based their work on Henrietta Lacks' cell cultures. Another non-fiction recommendation came from Linda in Juliaetta, who recommended "Goodbye, Boise Hello, Alaska," by Cora

Holmes, which is the true story of a woman answering an ad for a housekeeper on a remote ranch in the Aleutian Islands.

Since some people like to read an entire series of books in the summer, Betsy recommended the Marcus Didius Falco mysteries, by Lindsey Davis, which take place in ancient Rome.

Betsy added that she likes books that transport her to another time or place. Similarly, Gleanne suggested the mysteries of Colin Cotterill, set in Laos. The first is called "The Coroner's Lunch," and the newest is called "Killed at the Whim of a Hat."

For family reading, Laurie recommended "The Water Seeker," by Kimberly Willis Holt, about a family journey on the Oregon Trail in the mid-19th century that combines the magical realism of Louise Erdrich, the lyricism of Willa Cather, and the gritty western flavor of Larry McMurtry. And for families with younger children, Sheila recommended the picture book "The Abandoned Lighthouse," by Albert Lamb, about a boy and his friends who find their way to an abandoned lighthouse where they save a ship from running aground.

Kaylene recommended "The Forgotten Garden," by Kate Morton, as a perfect vacation novel, with multi-generational storylines, understated romance, unexpected plot turns and even a mysterious cottage in Cornwall.

And Betty, from the Troy Friends, recommended "The Girl in the Blue Beret," by Bobbie Ann Mason, about an American pilot in World War II who is shot down in Belgium and must make his way to Paris and Spain, and who learns of the war experience through the eyes of those helping him along the way.

Anne recommended "Cold Wind," by C.J. Box, who is coming to the Palouse in November as the author of the 2011 Everybody Reads selection, "Blue Heaven." Anne said this is her first encounter with Box's Joe Pickett series, and she's enjoying the action, the Wyoming setting, and the regular-guy game warden hero.

Check these out at your local library, and hope you have a good summer.

George Williams is the account services manager of Latah County Library District.

